Exam 1 Tips

```
$ how not to lose easy points
```

#1: Practice WITHOUT AI

PRACTICE PRACTICE PRACTICE

- Write code **yourself**
- Debug it **yourself** when it breaks
- No AI on the exam, so don't let the exam be the first time you do this alone

Compiler errors

If your code **doesn't compile**, you lose **50%** of the credit on that question.

- A LOT of the time it's just a missing ;
- But you have to get used to **reading the error message**. It tells you the line! Sometimes it's one line away.
- Practice fixing compiler errors **WITHOUT AI**. Seriously.
- MAKE SURE YOUR CODE COMPILES!

Reminders from previous labs

- **Turn off VS Code AI now:** Settings → `chat.disableAIFeatures`
- **Segmentation fault?** Add `-fsanitize=address,undefined` to your Makefile CFLAGS section. Or compile manually with `gcc` with that flag. **It will tell you the line! It will also tell you if you leaked memory!** (altho double check with valgrind)
- **Pointers confusing?** A few options:
  - Review lecture slides
  - Review my memory visualizer slides:

    `github.com/storchdev/cs-materials/.../memory-c-programmer.pdf`
  - Ask AI to help build a **mental model** that works
    - Ask it to explain why code works/doesn't work
  - Just keep practicing until you get it
  - Ask on Discord, office hours, a friend...

Need extra practice?

- **HackerRank**, **CodeChef**
- **Ask AI for new problems:** give it your old labs/assignments and ask for new ones like it

Using AI to **generate practice** = great.
Using AI to **solve the practice** = pointless.

FOCUS on memory and pointers

This is the part that trips people up. Spend your time HERE.

DO NOT just throw random `*` and `&` around until it compiles.

If you're still doing this, **you don't know it well enough yet**. That's fine, but fix it BEFORE the exam.

Still stuck? Discord, office hours, a friend, AI. **Just ask!**

Questions?

Office hours (Hudson)

Monday, 12:15 PM to 2:15 PM @ ITE 214

Discord

Ask any time

I will try to be quick!

Credits:

Slides made with Typst (typst.app) w/ help from Gen. AI